Hearth Hold - How to Play

Goal

Lead a tiny colony around a campfire called the Hearth. Gather, farm and build so your settlers stay fed, rested and happy, and hold off raiders who attack at dusk. Survive 30 days to win, then keep going for a record. The colony ends if the Hearth is destroyed or every settler dies.

Controls (phone)

Pick a tool in the bottom bar, then tap a tile. Settlers do the work on their own.

Drag your finger with Chop, Mine or Wall to mark or build along a line.

Remove refunds 50% of a finished building (100% if unfinished) and clears marks.

Rally (sword) sends every settler to fight while raiders are on the map.

? opens help and pauses. The note button toggles music. Desktop: keys 1-6 pick tools, X = Remove, Space = Rally.

Tools and buildings

Chop: mark trees. Each tree gives 3 loads of 4 wood.

Mine: mark rocks. Each rock gives 3 loads of 3 stone.

Farm (8 wood): grows during daytime and glows gold when ripe. A harvest gives 5 food.

Hut (20 wood): 2 beds (faster rest and healing) and room for 2 more settlers.

Wall (4 stone): raiders must break through it. Settlers can pass.

Tower (10 wood, 15 stone): shoots raiders within about 3.5 tiles.

Settlers

Each settler has health, hunger, rest and mood. They eat at the Hearth (1 food a meal, about 1 food a day each) and sleep at night.

Hungry, tired or grieving settlers lose mood. At very low mood a settler stops working for a few seconds.

At dawn a new settler joins if you have a free bed space and enough spare food.

Settlers defend themselves and the Hearth automatically; badly hurt settlers back off to recover.

Raiders

Raids start at dusk on day 3, every other night until day 10, then every night. Each raid is bigger and tougher.

The top bar says "raid tonight!" during the day before a raid.

Tips

Start with 2 farms and mark a few trees right away.

Build a hut before day 3 so your colony can grow.

Put towers close to the Hearth and ring them with walls.

Keep food above twice your settler count.

The colony auto-saves; Continue Colony picks up where you left off.